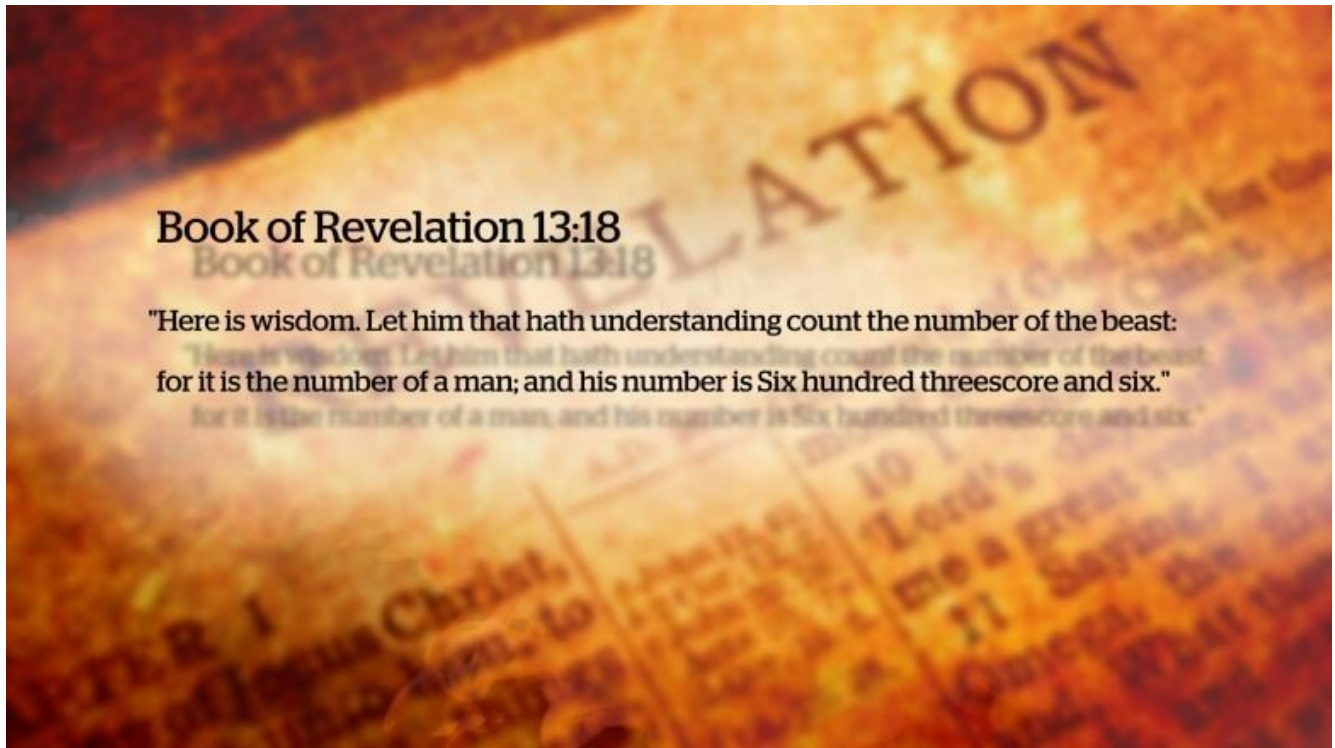


THE NUMBER OF THE BEAST

Lanthano 4/25/2025



DISCLAIMER

When I began investigating the mark of the Beast, I believed that the Tribulation was a future event. This is no longer what I believe. To see my case for what Revelation is about, when it happened, and why I believe this, please read *Postmillennial Preterism* by Samuel Swartz at: <https://drive.proton.me/urls/T2S13JEA74#gYzrBFHplWWa>

IS IT JUST A NUMBER?

The mark of the beast is something that is terrifyingly fascinating. It is a mark that many will receive in the end times, but once a person has taken it, they will not be allowed into heaven.

And he [the beast] causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads:

And that no man might buy or sell, save he that had the mark, or the name of the beast, or the number of his name.

Here is wisdom. Let him that hath understanding count the number of the beast: for it is the number of a man; and his number is Six hundred threescore and six.

(KJV, Revelation 13:16-18)

And the third angel followed them, saying with a loud voice, If any man worship the beast and his image, and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand,

The same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God, which is poured out without mixture into the cup of his indignation; and he shall be tormented with fire and brimstone in the presence of the holy angels, and in the presence of the Lamb:

(KJV, Revelation 14:9-10)

The Bible makes it clear that the mark of the beast will be a terrifying thing. Nothing to be toyed with.

But what will it look like? Will the mark be a microchip? A bar-code tattooed into your skin? Could it be something else completely? Like a vaccine or some kind of shot?

BISMILLAH

Bismillah is derived from Arabic, it translates to "in the name of Allah" or "in the name of God." It is a phrase used by Muslims to invoke guidance, protection, and blessings. It shows reliance and dedication to Allah. It is often used to begin a prayer, at meals, and other activities.^{A1}

If John (the author of Revelation), saw a world where everyone was a Muslim, and had *Bismillah* tattooed on either their right hand or forehead, he could have easily thought they all were wearing the Greek number 666.

Six hundred threescore and six in Greek can be written multiple ways.^{A2}

When written as a number, 666 is: χξς (chi xi stigma)

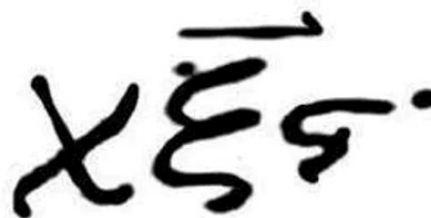
When written in words, six hundred sixty-six is written as: ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ (hexakósioi hexēkonta héx)

When 666 is written as a number, it looks identical to *Bismillah*. (To the right, you can see that 666 in Greek,

The Bismillah Mark



Crossed Swords Allah In the name of



The Greek spelling of 666

and *Bismillah* in Arabic, look almost identical.)

While χξς and *Bismillah* are extremely similar, if you look at some original Greek manuscripts for Revelation 13:18, the characters χξς do not appear. Instead you see 666 spelled out in words: ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ.

That seems to destroy the idea that *Bismillah* is what John was seeing. Many argue that this proves that John wasn't seeing *Bismillah* in the vision, because we don't see χξς in the texts.

But, if he had seen *Bismillah* in the vision (thinking they were all wearing the number 666 and having no knowledge of modern Arabic), when he went to record what he saw, he might have wrote the number in words instead.

It is also possible that χξς was in the original texts written by John, and that later versions spelled the numbers out instead. Manuscripts in the Textus Receptus (from which the KJV is based), when reading Revelation, we see 666 written in number form.

Here is a short list of manuscripts and their rendering the number in Revelation 13:18:^{A3}

Stephanus Textus Receptus 1550: χξς (666)

Scrivener's Textus Receptus 1894: χξς' (666)

Nestle 1904: ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ (six hundred sixty-six)

Westcott and Hort 1881: ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ (six hundred sixty-six)

Westcott and Hort / [NA27 and UBS4 variants]: ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ (six hundred sixty-six)

RP Byzantine Majority Text 2005: ἑξακόσια ἑξήκοντα ἕξ (six hundred sixty-six)

Greek Orthodox Church: χξς' (666)

Tischendorf 8th Edition: χξς (666)

In the end, sometimes the number is written down in number form, other times spelled out. But it can and should be recognized that, if John the Apostle did see *Bismillah* in his vision, he might have mistaken it for, and written down six hundred sixty-six instead.

The number sometimes being written in words does not destroy the idea that the mark of the beast might be the Muslim *Bismillah*.

NERO CAESAR



Nero was the first Caesar to persecute the Christians of Rome. He was extremely cruel and evil, and when he died, rumors spread that he was resurrect and return someday.

With that said, if you take the name Nero Caesar, and put it in Hebrew characters, you get: NRON QSRN. When you add up their Hebrew value, you get 666.^{B1}

This is a fun fact, but doesn't prove anything on it's own. Especially with two other manuscripts reading 616 as the number of the beast (Papyrus 115 and Codex Ephraemi Rescriptus).

However, there is a theory for this. It's that the number 616 comes from unknown earlier Latin manuscripts. This stems from the fact that when Nero is put into Latin characters and the final N is dropped (NRO QSR), it adds up to exactly 616.

Some argue that this means Revelation is speaking of events passed and that Nero was the Antichrist. Others claim it indicates that the beast originates from the Roman Catholic Church, or that Nero is coming back as the Antichrist.

The issue with this idea is merely the fact that we cannot prove that Papyrus 115 and Codex Ephraemi Rescriptus were based off earlier Latin documents.

Nero in Hebrew adds to 666, as most manuscripts show. And even if you are using the other two manuscripts, Nero also adds to 616 in Latin.

SOURCES

BISMILLAH

[A1] The Muslim perspective, and use of Bismillah: <https://www.noorinstitutes.com/bismillah-meaning/>

[A2] Six hundred sixty-six in Greek: <https://biblehub.com/greek/5516.htm>; *Bismillah* in Arabic:

[A3] Which manuscripts contain χξς, and which ἑξακόσιοι ἑξήκοντα ἕξ:
<https://biblehub.com/text/revelation/13-18.htm>

NERO CAESAR

[B1] Nero in Hebrew equals 666, and in Latin it is 616:
<https://www.detroitcatholic.com/voices/does-666-add-up-to-nero>

TABLE OF CONTENTS

THE NUMBER OF THE BEAST.....	1
DISCLAIMER.....	1
IS IT JUST A NUMBER?.....	2
BISMILLAH.....	2
NERO CAESAR.....	3
SOURCES.....	5
BISMILLAH.....	5
NERO CAESAR.....	5